

Spotlight: Political Machines

Part 1: Please start with this short reading about political machines (on the back of this paper) and answer the following questions. If you need to translate, level down, or want the article read to you, please open the assignment in Kami:

- a. What were the common demands on city leaders at the time? (Name at least three)

- b. How did a political boss maintain power?

- c. Who did political bosses appeal to (focus on) most?

- d. How did political machines engage in voter fraud?

- e. Who was the most notorious political boss of the age?

Part 2: One of the most famous examples of the corruption of political machines and political bosses is the story of William Marcy Tweed, Boss Tweed, the political boss of Tammany Hall. [Watch the following video about Boss Tweed from the Bill of Rights Institute \(4:24\)](#) and answer the following questions. If needed, YouTube has closed captions and a transcript for the Boss Tweed video.

- a. What are some good things (at least 3) that Boss Tweed was able to do?

- b. Why is Boss Tweed remembered negatively in history?